"All the News That's Fit to Print"

# The New York Times

**THE WEATHER**
**Today,** partly cloudy, winds light and variable, high 67. **Tonight,** partly cloudy, winds light and variable, low 52. **Tomorrow,** partly sunny, high 71. Weather map appears on Page A24.

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KARSTEN MORAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

**A City Aglow**
A pack in Brooklyn during Sunday's New York City Marathon. The approximately 60,000 participants included a surprise winner who was making his debut. Section F.

## TRUMP IS RISKING EDGE U.S. SCIENCE HAS IN RESEARCH

### FORCING A NEW AGENDA

### Cost-Cutting and Politics Lead to Lost Jobs and Wide Uncertainty

*This article is by* ***Christopher Flavelle, Irena Hwang, Adam Sella, Alan Blinder, Sheryl Gay Stolberg, Benjamin Mueller*** *and* ***Michael C. Bender.***

The warning, buried in an obscure government report this summer, was unflinching.

The Defense Department's vaunted network of research laboratories — whose scientists helped develop satellite communication, radar technology, and even the computer mouse — was in trouble.

The labs lost a significant share of their staff last year, largely in response to the Trump administration's efforts to thin the federal work force, the report found. Refilling critical positions was proving difficult partly because of President Trump's demand that new hires be screened for their loyalty to his goals. The report, issued by the Pentagon, pointed to "potentially grave consequences for the future of national defense."

The turmoil inside scientific research has extended beyond the Pentagon. The Energy Department, a key hub of nuclear and quantum research, has lost more than 1,000 scientists and technical staff members. The National Science Foundation, for decades a primary backer of long-term, foundational research, has withheld more than $1 billion in funding.

And at the National Institutes of Health, the biggest funder of medical research, officials delayed or canceled more than 2,000 grants to biomedical researchers focused on topics such as Alzheimer's,

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**SCIENCE UNDER SIEGE**
*Dismantling a Machine*

## *Rival Beaten By El-Sayed Backs Rogers*

*This article is by* ***Bayliss Wagner, Reid J. Epstein*** *and* ***Tim Balk.***

Representative Haley Stevens, Democrat of Michigan, on Sunday withdrew her support for Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, the Democratic nominee for Senate in the state and her former primary rival, and endorsed his Republican opponent, a stunning last-minute turn in a race that is critical to the battle for Senate control.

"Our Democratic nominee for U.S. Senate, Abdul, said that I was no longer welcome in his campaign and that I should stay away," Ms. Stevens said in a video on social media. "And he's right. And that's why I am endorsing Mike Rogers for the United States Senate."

The extraordinary development reflected both the bitter disagreements over Israel and the personal animosity between the two prominent Michigan Democrats.

Ms. Stevens, a moderate and a strong supporter of Israel, often clashed with Dr. El-Sayed, an outspoken progressive critic of the country, during their contentious primary race. After he narrowly beat her in August, she immediately endorsed him and they seemed to reach a quiet truce. Then, last month, she began to criticize him in news interviews, and in recent days, they traded public barbs over his stance on Israel. But she continued to cautiously commit to supporting Dr. El-Sayed and the full Democratic ticket.

Ms. Stevens's endorsement video went online while she appeared on Sunday morning with Mr. Rogers at a Black church in De-

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**TEST IN MICHIGAN** Abdul El-Sayed's fate will show the left's potency looking ahead. PAGE A10

**DISMISSAL IN ALASKA** A judge rejected an attempt to contest the results of a Senate race. PAGE A15

## As Republicans Copy Trump's Style, Vicious Attacks Set New Low

### Crude Tarring of Rivals in Midterm Messages Tests Voters' Limits

**By TIM BALK and SAM EASTER**

In Kansas, Senator Roger Marshall, a vulnerable Republican, baselessly said his Democratic opponent "probably is grooming" children.

In Texas, Republicans have cast James Talarico, the Democratic Senate nominee, as a "freak" and insinuated he is gay, secretly a vegan, and obsessed with transgender children because he made statements supporting them in the past.

And in Michigan, Republicans have targeted the Democratic Senate nominee, Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, with Islamophobic attacks. President Trump has described Dr. El-Sayed as a "vicious, violent jihadist."

Facing a backlash over rising prices and working to overcome the president's deep unpopularity, Republicans across the country have tarred their opponents with false, inflammatory and deeply personal attacks in the final stretch of the midterm election.

In many cases, they are following the lead of a president who has repeatedly rewritten the rules of acceptable discourse in American politics. Many of the attacks have drawn little pushback from within the party, but some Republicans say they are concerned by the trend.

"It's awful," said former Senator Jeff Flake, an Arizona Republican and critic of Mr. Trump. Mr. Flake, who is backing candidates in both parties in the midterms, said Republicans had gone down a darker road in their messaging: "We've gotten progressively more crass and crude and vulgar. But this seems to be a new level."

The strategy risks turning off some moderate voters who see the rhetoric as over-the-top or offensive, political observers said. But it could be effective at energiz-

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SAM BUSH FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Karl Bushby, in London, is nearing the end of a walking tour of the globe that began in late 1998.

## Around the World, on Just His Feet, in 28 Years

**By JONATHAN WOLFE**

LONDON — Karl Bushby's plan to walk across the globe began with a note in a birthday card.

It was the mid-1990s and Mr. Bushby was a paratrooper in the British Army, obsessed with endurance tests. He was trying to find the longest distance he could travel by foot, but none of his options felt challenging enough, maxing out at a few thousand miles. Then his father suggested in the card that he look into traversing the Bering Strait between Alaska and Russia when it froze in the winter — unlocking a path across four continents.

Never mind that crossing the perilous waterway on foot had little modern precedent. Mr. Bushby took a black marker, walked to a map on his wall and drew a line from England, where he lived, through Europe and Asia, across the strait into North America and down to the southernmost tip of South America.

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**NEWS ANALYSIS**

## *Putin Edges Out of Isolation, With Big Assist From Trump*

**By PAUL SONNE**

BERLIN — He took a rare call from the Finnish and Norwegian leaders. He hosted Qatar's emir and Iran's president at a forum of gas-exporting countries.

And he squired African heads of state around a Moscow exhibition, advising them to control social media networks in their own nations, or risk mass protests like those that have gripped France. There, he promoted Russia's answer to Starlink, but said Russia was in close contact with Elon Musk, whom he called "a brilliant man."

President Vladimir V. Putin of Russia engaged in a frenzy of diplomatic activity in the Russian capital this past week that underscored how, nearly five years into his war against Ukraine, he is thwarting Western attempts to isolate him and muscling his way back to center stage in global affairs.

Mr. Putin has been winning praise, high-level invitations and concessions from the United States, even while escalating the war and showing no intention of compromising. The news that the Trump administration is considering lifting sanctions on Russia's flagship government invest-



POOL PHOTO BY ANASTASIA BARASHKOVA

President Vladimir V. Putin at the Russia-Africa Summit.

ment fund came after President Trump agreed to import Russian diesel fuel and the U.S. special envoy, Steve Witkoff, praised Mr. Putin as a humanitarian.

"In the Kremlin, I think they are really celebrating," said Stefan Meister, a Russia analyst at the German Council on Foreign Relations. He added, "No matter what they are doing or not doing, they are getting things they didn't even expect."

Mr. Putin is scheduled to travel to Shenzhen, China, in November for the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum, where a possible trilateral meeting with

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**Bangkok's Top Snake Catcher**
Pinyo Pukpinyo captures dozens a week. But he refuses to kill them, and he's running out of containers. PAGE A4

**Arab Parties Surge in Israel**
Having won a record 19 Knesset seats, they say they want to help take down the Netanyahu government. PAGE A8

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**Tap Water Stirs Bitter Debate**
Council candidates in Scottsdale, Ariz., disagree on whether recycling wastewater into drinking water is smart policy or a dangerous remedy. PAGE A9

**Tight Contest in New Jersey**
Representative Thomas H. Kean Jr., a Republican, is facing a tough challenge from Rebecca Bennett, a Democrat. Profiles of the candidates. PAGES A16-17

**Fallout From Mayoral Clash**
After Zohran Mamdani sought to remove the head of the Commission on Racial Equity, some are doubting his commitment to reparations. PAGE A19

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A.I. has uncovered a horde of software flaws, which engineers in Silicon Valley are racing to fix before they can be exploited by hackers. PAGE B1

**Dominating Mideast Oil Trade**
Since September, Sinokor has controlled about half the tanker transits through the Strait of Hormuz. PAGE B1

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Ursula von Rydingsvard was known for monumental forms made from cedar beams. She was 84. PAGE A20



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But Cynthia Nixon admires her "Sex and the City" alter ego and knows she will always be defined by her. PAGE C1

**Taking Shakespeare Aloft**
Patrick Stewart often delivered richly spoken classical language to express a cosmic sense of hope or grief. PAGE C1

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Golden State's billionaire owner promised a W.N.B.A. championship within five years. It took only two. PAGE D6

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The lottery candidates and scoring stars worth watching this season in the men's and women's games. PAGE D4-5

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**Michelle Goldberg** PAGE A23